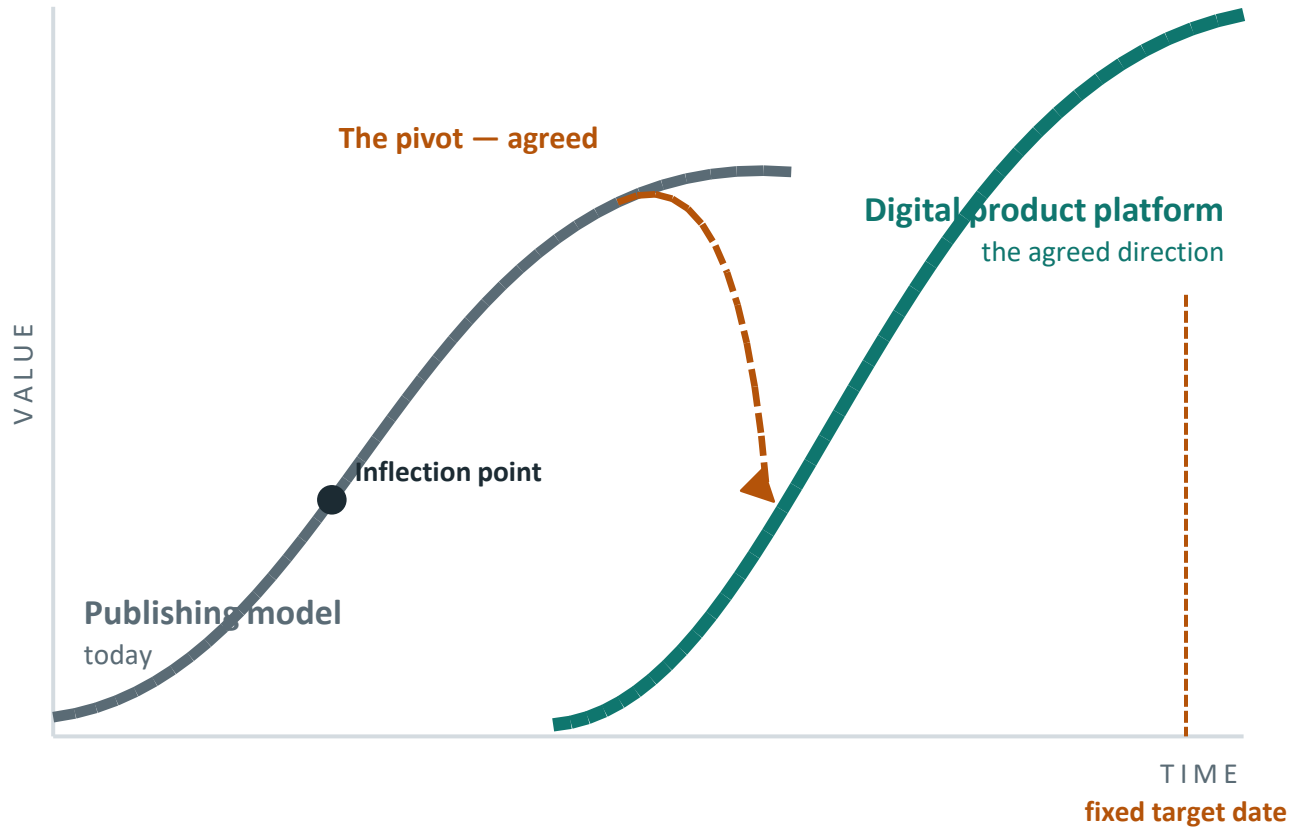
Own the agreed pathway without stalling it: understand, stabilise, accelerate



Understand

DAYS 1–30

two baselines: the technology and the ways of working

Stabilise

DAYS 31–60

keep today running; assess the proposal; confirm, re-scope or stop

Accelerate

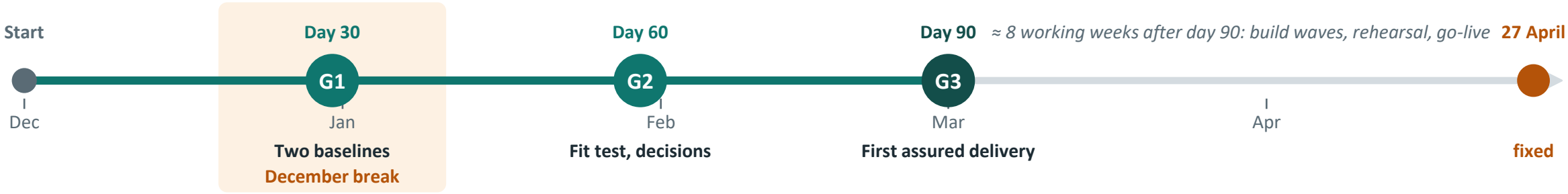
DAYS 61–90 →

first assured delivery; the plan to the date

Every design and staffing statement that follows is a hypothesis. Gates 1 and 2 test it before anything is built.

Nothing that works today stops until its replacement is proven.

A December start leaves little room: three gates by early March, then eight weeks to go live



Technology and product baseline

Systems, integrations, contracts, partners, run cost; licence model; what is in flight

Ways-of-working baseline

Processes, SOPs, SLAs, mandated requirements; hand-offs; what each ceremony produces

The fit test — at Gate 2

Does the proposal support the way we want to work?

Is each component in the right tier, under the right rule?

THE REALITY: PROTECT WHAT WORKS, AND HOLD THE SCOPE

- **Start in December**
  The break takes three of the first four weeks; Gate 1 lands mid-January in practice, so the baselines are a fortnight of work, not a month
- **Day 90 is early March**
  About eight working weeks remain for build waves, a cutover rehearsal and go-live before 27 April
- **Don’t break what is working**
  Nothing that works today stops until its replacement is proven; in-flight work is confirmed or stopped by Gate 1
- **Work with the team in place**
  The plan assumes the people and partners we have; new hires or proposals are not baked into it
- **Scope is the only lever**
  No growth on hoped-for AI or efficiency gains, no slippage on quality or risk; what does not fit moves to Day 1.5
- **Decide early, in writing**
  Any scope-versus-date trade-off goes to the board at Gate 2, in late January — not in April

ILLUSTRATIVE — NOT A DECISION

Four questions per component: what it is decides where time, money and concern go

	1 What kind of thing is it?	2 Spending judged on?	3 How resilient?	4 Build or buy?	OPTIONAL UPLIFT Where AI helps
A	AMH Online — web, desktop, mobile, and the APIs into third-party systems	Commercials, opportunity, strategy	Bullet-proof: life-critical content	Build: strong appetite to wrap our own technical solutions	+ Accelerate and de-risk product work
B	Quark Content and PriXM — authoring and publishing	Fit for authors, portability, cost	Business hours; never the only copy	Buy and configure: plugins, paid features, small code where it pays	+ Author assistance; human sign-off
C	D365 / Dataverse, WooCommerce shop, D365 internal shop, Wiise, Power BI	Cost and effort vs efficiency gained	Standard; no shared fate	Buy: standard set-up; deviate by exception only	+ Woven into process; must-haves shrink
X	Azure identity and access plane, API gateway / service bus, monitoring, ISMS and standards	Inherits, plus risk and reputation	Inherits A wherever it sits in A's path	Buy, but bend to accommodate A and third parties	+ Review, triage, runbooks

ILLUSTRATIVE — NOT A DECISION

Five kinds of protection: in full for the five-nines product, proportionate for the rest

1 · Isolate

no shared fate

- Hub and spoke; commodity behind the bus — A X C
- Published content at the edge (CDN) — A
- Entitlements cached, with grace — A X
- Read-only degraded mode — A
- Bulkheads, circuit breakers, back-pressure — A X

2 · Replicate

no single point

- Active-active across regions — A X
- Stateless services, replicated data — A X
- Identity-provider outage plan — A X
- SaaS and vendor failover plans — A B C
- Capacity headroom and load testing — A X

3 · Release safely

no big-bang change

- Feature switches — ship dark, release deliberately — A
- Blue/green deployment — A
- Canary by cohort, automated rollback — A
- Configuration changes versioned and staged — A B C
- Immutable, versioned content releases — A B

4 · Detect and respond

minutes, not hours

- SLOs and error budgets — A
- Synthetic checks from customer locations — A X
- Runbooks; 24×7 on-call via MSP — A X C
- Status page and incident comms — A X B C
- Game days and DR drills (RTO/RPO) — A X C

5 · Protect content

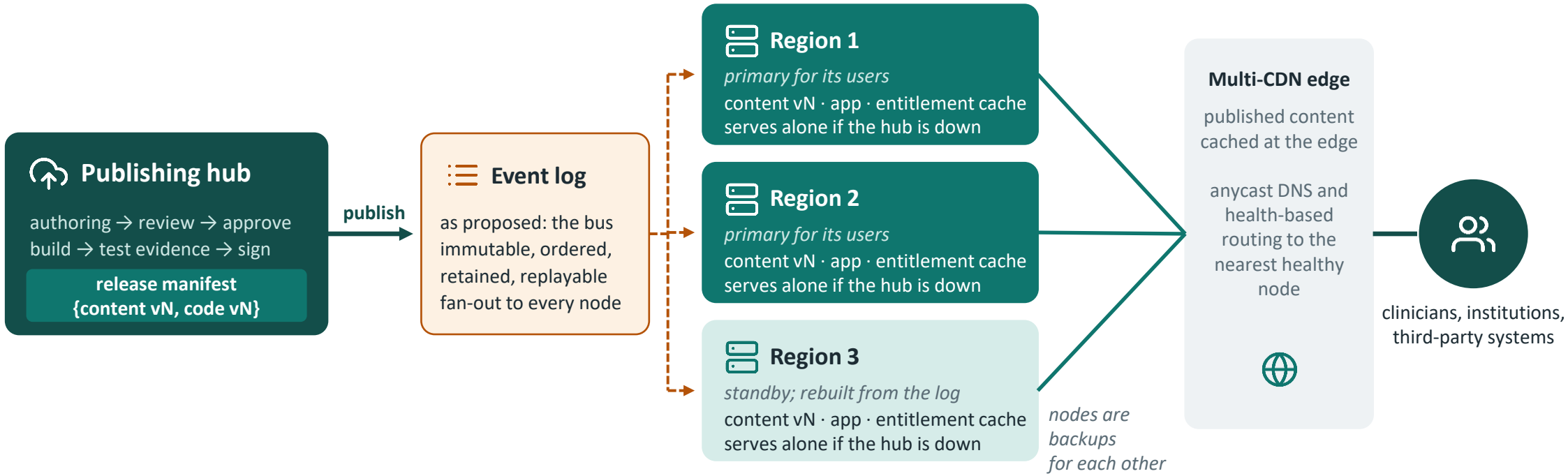
integrity above all

- Content checksums and integrity checks — A B
- Copies held outside the authoring tool — A B
- Replay from the bus after outages — A C
- Backups and restore drills for CRM, shop, finance — A C
- Audit trail: what changed, when, who — A B C

Badges show which tiers each mechanism applies to. The product (A) gets all of them; B and C get the proportionate set that avoids a slow week, not a lost minute; X carries the product's mechanisms where it sits in the product's path.

ILLUSTRATIVE — NOT A DECISION

One publishing hub, regional nodes that serve alone, rollback by re-pointing



ROLLBACK IN THIS WORLD

- Rolling back is re-pointing to vN-1 — seconds, no redeploy
- Content and code roll back together: the manifest binds them
- A lost node is rebuilt by replaying the log — no restore from backup
- Canary: publish to one node or cohort, watch the SLO, then fan out

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS — TO EVALUATE, NOT CHANGES

Event backbone: replay and ordering	**Kafka-class log**
Institutional single sign-on	**Shibboleth / SAML**
Learning-platform integration	**LTI / LIS**
Clinical and prescribing systems	**clinical standards**
Information security management	**ISMS / ISO 27001**
Clinical publishing governance	**provenance, errata**

ILLUSTRATIVE — NOT A DECISION

A minimum viable team of six

MINIMUM VIABLE TEAM — WHO OWNS WHAT

CTO	Strategy, architecture, transformation, project management, roadmap *vs proposal: tweaked responsibilities*	A B C X
Technical Lead	Standards, build, maintain, technical QA	A X B
Developer	Build, maintain, technical QA *vs proposal: new — replaces the 0.6 PM*	A X
Platform Engineer (DevSecOps)	Security, ISMS, platform, pipeline *vs proposal was DevOps Engineer;*	X A B
Digital Product Owner	Project, research, design *vs proposal research, design added*	A B C
QA / BA	User testing, QA, product assistance *vs proposal was part-time BA; QA made focus*	A C

Responsibilities, not an approved hiring plan.

OPTIONS GATE 2 WOULD CHOOSE BETWEEN

Second Developer, or the vendor's 0.6 PM

how much of the product is built in-house

AI budget and AI-DLC adoption instead of more headcount

assist, accelerate and de-risk product work

NOT IN THE TEAM — PARTNER OR MSP

Managed service provider — office IT

- Laptops, printers, phones and internet

Specialist partners — bought in when needed

- Independent security testing and certification
- Expert help on vendors' systems (CRM, shop, finance)

Outside the team's remit

- Content operations

One operating rhythm, gates sized to the tier, judged on outcomes rather than AI activity

OPERATING RHYTHM — WHO SEES WHAT

Board / Risk Committee
quarterly, with a monthly review pack · date confidence, gate sign-off, risks, spend

Delivery and Partner Review
weekly, CEO invited · cycle time, change failure, blockers, decisions pending

Architecture decisions
written down, visible to all

ASSURANCE GATES BY TIER — EVERY INCREMENT, EVIDENCE NOT MEETINGS

	A	B	C	X
Security, payments and ISMS	●		●	●
Data and privacy	●	●	●	
Content integrity and clinical governance	●	●		
Integration and operability	●		●	●
Release readiness	●	●		●

A product · B content tooling · C commodity · X cross-cutting

THE NEXT SIX MONTHS

Months 1–2
two baselines, fit test, scope decisions to the board

Months 3–4
first assured delivery on the core; partners delivering

Months 5–6
build waves, cutover rehearsal, go-live against the date

Not commitments, not walked through today — parked until their time comes

DAY 1.5 — IDEAS WALL: PARKED, UNSORTED, JUDGED BY TIER WHEN THEIR TIME COMES

- Unified communications
- Product analytics and behaviour
- In-app guidance and onboarding
- Inline surveys and sentiment
- Feature switches, progressive delivery
- Search as a product capability
- Developer and API portal
- Consent and preferences
- Status page and incident comms
- Integration standards: SSO, LTI/LIS, clinical
- Content versioning visible to customers
- Accessibility and offline mobile

DAY 2 — ALREADY ON THE PATHWAY

- Assistant over authoritative content — citations, no generated clinical text
- Internal operational AI on the same platform
- Subscription and user-update integration

Yellow product · orange cross-cutting · green content tooling. Day 1.5 = after the agreed path is live, before Day 2.